

Roland Imhoff:

I forgot to add this comment by Ulrich Schimmack at Facebook Psychological methods discussion group, to the decision letter. I know that it reached you on Facebook, but it should of course have been included in the decision letter along with the formal reviews so that everyone without Facebook can read it.

I haven't read a social psychology article with so much interest in a long time. Who thought it would be boring to see the actual results of interesting studies (as a German the topic of course also has some personal significance).

I am afraid to say anything critical, but given all of these results I wonder about the original study. To me it is most probably that it was just a statistical fluke.

If we assume based on the following studies that the null-hypothesis is (approximately) true, we can actually use the p-value of the original study as the probability of observing the interaction (or an even stronger one).

$F(1,44) = 5.86, p = .020 (1/50)$.

1 out of 50 is not often, but also not terribly uncommon given the many studies that are being conducted in social psychology.

I am also still trying to wrap my head around the results for implicit attitudes. Shouldn't you see an effect on implicit attitude measures as well. Maybe not moderated by the bogus pipeline manipulation but as a main effect of the suffering-manipulation?

It seems to me that the original results could be explained by a statistical fluke and no hidden moderators are needed to explain why subsequent studies failed to replicate this finding.

But as I said, publishing the file drawer is a historic event in social psychology. As a single study is a singularity it will be impossible to know for sure why this study produced different results than the others.